

Stella Maris Santamaría

SENIOR FRONTEND DEVELOPER | REACT & TYPESCRIPT | PRODUCT UI & DESIGN SYSTEMS

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Senior Frontend Developer with 6+ years of experience building React and TypeScript applications, backed by UX Development, UX Design, and Graphic Design. I work across design, product, and engineering, turning design intent into responsive production UI and reusable frontend systems. I have a track record of independently identifying gaps, investigating ambiguous problems, and turning them into concrete solutions, from frontend architecture proposals and production migrations to AI/agentic workflows adopted by real teams.

SELECTED FRONTEND IMPACT

Frontend UI ecosystem: Identified a missing UI strategy during a frontend rearchitecture and started a 3-month initiative covering styling, shared components, Design System adoption, responsive strategy, UI libraries, performance, repository workflow, and documentation. Defined the proposal and implementation plan for a repository shared by five teams.

AI-assisted FE workflow: Designed and built a custom Claude Code workflow from scratch around specs, human review, persistent product knowledge, context recovery, and Backend and QA handoffs. Presented it to the FE team and Engineering Management, and it was adopted by the team.

Component libraries and Design Systems: Built and maintained React and TypeScript components for a production component library, created Storybook documentation standards, contribution and release documentation, and a Design System-oriented Storybook template. Also built a component library POC for Making Sense.

End-to-end delivery and frontend leadership: Worked for about one year as the sole Frontend Developer alongside three Backend Developers, delivering more than ten initiatives to production. Later led day-to-day frontend planning and delivery for a five-person team.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Frontend Developer

Making Sense LLC | Argentina | May 2022 – Present

- Build production React and TypeScript interfaces from design specs, combining business rules, interaction states, responsive behavior, state management, Design System alignment, and REST API integration.
- Collaborate with UX and Product to clarify missing states, edge cases, reusable UI opportunities, and technical constraints, suggesting implementation alternatives when needed.
- Contribute to the client's component library and break complex product work into frontend tasks, estimates, dependencies, and implementation plans.
- Lead Focus AI FE, an internal initiative focused on practical AI adoption. Current work also includes extending the FE AI workflow toward Product collaboration and designing an AI Suite for Library Migrations.

Key contributions

- Frontend UI Ecosystem Proposal: Led the initiative end to end for three months. Mapped UI problems, ran technical spikes and POCs, audited the component ecosystem, defined proposals across eight areas, coordinated contributions

across an 11-person frontend group, and presented the final proposal and phased implementation plan to client-side Engineering Management.

- **AI-assisted FE Workflow:** Designed and built a custom SDD-based Claude Code workflow with specs, specialized review agents, persistent product knowledge, context recovery, developer-controlled transitions, and FE handoffs to Backend and QA. Adopted by the FE team and iterated through real usage.
- **React Query v2 to v5 migration:** Designed and led the migration strategy for almost 1,000 affected files. Defined dependency-aware phases, dual-version coexistence, rollback boundaries, QA tracking, and pre/post metrics. Used Codex and Copilot for repetitive transformations while retaining ownership of decisions and validation. The process became the FE team's framework for future library migrations.
- **Vitest adoption proposal:** Investigated recurring Jest issues and uncovered an architectural mismatch with the Vite and ESM stack. Built a POC, ran comparative benchmarks, and presented the technical proposal. The client approved it in the same meeting, and Making Sense later showcased the presentation internally as a successful technical proposal approach.
- **Platform problem solving:** Designed an AI-assisted Phrase safe-rename workflow after identifying a hidden production risk, and expanded a module-scoped permissions spike into a shared FE and BE permissions-refresh strategy adopted across the application.
- **FE Team Lead, 5-person team:** Led frontend planning and delivery for about one year, including task breakdown, SWAG estimations, dependency planning, sequencing, PR reviews, blocker follow-up, onboarding, and process documentation.
- **Sole Frontend Developer:** Worked alongside three Backend Developers for about one year, owning frontend delivery for more than ten production initiatives and presenting biweekly demos in English to client-side Engineering Management and stakeholders.

Semi Senior UX Developer

Making Sense LLC | Argentina | Dec 2019 – May 2022

- **Component library and Design Systems:** Built and maintained React and TypeScript components for a versioned production component library using styled-components and Storybook. Created Storybook documentation standards, contribution and release documentation, and a Design System-oriented template.
- **Production UI:** Translated UX and UI designs into React and TypeScript interfaces and reusable components with attention to layout, interaction states, responsiveness, and Design System alignment.
- **Making Sense component library POC:** Built a React and TypeScript component library POC from scratch, defining component architecture, Storybook setup, and documentation standards.
- **Sole UX Developer:** Supported two client teams across the main platform and one product module for about one year.
- **Onboarding, mentoring, and hiring:** Designed the UX Developer onboarding program, delivered basic React training, and created a GitHub Pages practice repository. Served as Career Advisor for up to three UX Developers and helped define and lead the technical hiring process.
- **Workshops and knowledge transfer:** Delivered workshops on UX laws, Design Systems, and UX Development practices. After moving into Frontend Engineering, delivered a knowledge-transfer workshop to the project's FE team.
- **Department documentation:** Created role definition, onboarding, team process, and UX to Frontend collaboration documentation.

Web Developer & UX Designer

El Águila Sanitarios | Argentina | Jan 2018 - May 2020

Designed and developed PrestaShop and WordPress sites. Created digital marketing materials for social media, blog, email campaigns, and brochures. Managed SEO and social media accounts.

Web Developer & Graphic Designer

Estudio MINT | Argentina | Oct 2019 - Dec 2019

Developed custom WordPress sites. Designed visuals for emails and social media. Created email marketing templates.

Freelance Web Developer & Graphic Designer

Freelance | Argentina | Jan 2011 - Nov 2019

Designed and developed WordPress and PrestaShop sites. Produced graphics for web, social media, and print.

UX Designer

Doppler | Argentina | Aug 2017 - Aug 2018

Designed email marketing templates for Doppler Wizard and custom clients using InVision. Created static and animated assets for digital campaigns. Performed image editing and optimization across multiple formats and use cases.

Web Developer, Graphic Designer & Online sales

El Águila Sanitarios | Argentina | Nov 2016 - Aug 2017

Developed and maintained custom eCommerce themes for WordPress, PrestaShop, and MercadoShops. Handled customer support and online sales. Produced assets for digital and print: signage, vehicle graphics, stationery, and social media. Managed social ads (Facebook Ads), SEO, and SEM campaigns.

TECH AND TOOLS

React, TypeScript, HTML5, CSS3, Storybook, styled-components, Vitest, React Testing Library, React Query, Zustand, REST API integration, GitHub Actions, GitHub, Git, npm/yarn, Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Codex, Agile/Scrum.

EDUCATION

Bachelor's Degree in Graphic Design & Audiovisual Communication | Universidad CAECE | Mar del Plata | 2011 - 2017

Certifications & Courses

UX & Interaction Design Diploma | UTN e-learning | 2019

Fullstack Development with ReactJS, NodeJS and MySQL | UTN e-learning | 2021

React & Firebase | UTN e-learning | 2020

Web & Mobile Prototyping | +Acumen | 2017

LANGUAGES

Spanish: Native

English: Professional working proficiency in technical contexts, including technical documentation, async communication, client-facing demos, and engineering discussions with US-based stakeholders

Italian: Full professional proficiency – PLIDA C1.